

playback at 80% volume. With ANC off and moderate use, you can eke out enough juice for a weekend outing.

Fast charging is practical too. I tested by draining the battery down, and it took close to 1 hour and 30 minutes to fully charge the device with a white LED indication. CMF says a 5-minute quick charging could fetch you 4 hours of playback. Good for morning commutes.

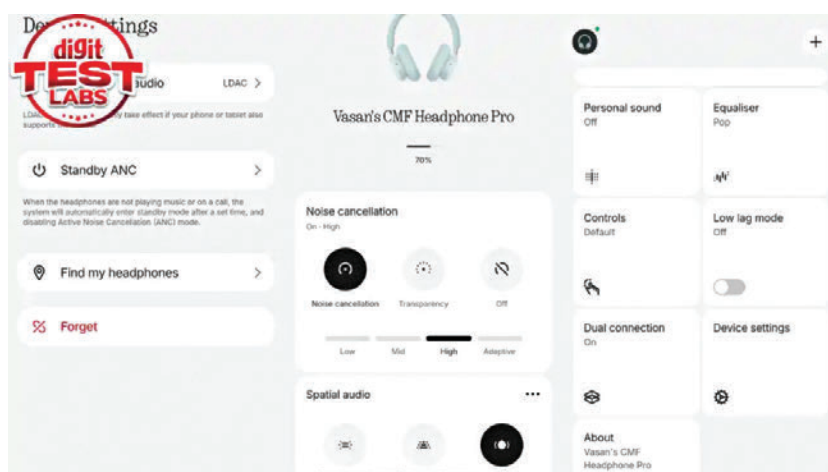
The headphone charges via USB-C. There's no wireless charging here. You can't use the headphones wired or wirelessly while they're charging. At least wired should work, I feel. But honestly, I barely had to charge it at all in normal use. The battery meter in the app is accurate, so I always knew how much juice was left.

There is no USB-C audio support, either. So, no, you can't listen through the USB-C port. It is for charging only. What's weird, though, is that you can listen via the 3.5mm cable only if the headphone is powered on.

FUN AND CLEAR SOUND

I tested the CMF Headphone Pro across a wide range of tracks, focusing on bass, mids, treble, presence, and stereo imaging. The performance is strong overall. Its limitations only become clear when compared directly with proper flagship headphones.

In Dream Theater's Pull Me Under, guitar riffs, bass lines, and drums remain mostly distinct, and James LaBrie's vocals sound clear, but in the



busy portions of the song, his sound feels slightly behind the guitar and other instrumental layers.

The bass drops on Billie Eilish's Bad Guy are tight. Just a reminder, I was listening to the Pop EQ profile with the Bass slider at its lowest setting. But raising it does make the bass sound boomy, if that's your preference. For instance, in Jeremy Soule's Dragonborn (Skyrim game soundtrack), the war drums get a rumbling effect with the bass slider raised.

VERDICT

After living with the CMF Headphone Pro for a few days, my takeaway is that it offers very strong value for the sub-Rs 8,000 mark. It looks intentionally playful and will appeal to people who like its cute charm or simply want something that doesn't blend into a sea

of serious-looking headphones.

The sound, while not neutral or flagship-grade, is engaging and easy to like. LDAC support adds flexibility for higher-quality streaming, and ANC is effective enough to make that experience calmer and private.

When so many things are done right, it's natural to expect the same level of polish everywhere. But considering its price, there are some noticeable restrictions like you can't use the headphones while they're charging.

Still, CMF's first headphones make the most sense for buyers who want something different from the usual serious-looking ANC headphones, and also value long battery life, comfort, and a fun, energetic sound. If that's what you're looking for, its compromises feel reasonable, and its strengths great.

—G. S. Vasani



SPECIFICATIONS

Driver: 40 mm custom dynamic drivers | Noise Cancellation: Hybrid Adaptive Active Noise Cancellation | Depth: Up to 40dB | Codecs: LDAC, AAC, SBC | IP Rating: IPX2 | Connectivity: Bluetooth 5.4 and 3.5 mm | Software: No App | Battery: 720 mAh

CONTACT

Company: Nothing Technology Ltd | Phone: 18002021232 | Email: Web Form | Website: <https://in.nothing.tech/>

Read more on Digit.in:
tinyurl.com/cm216hxs